Product Requirements Document: brianaaugustina.com

Overview

A personal website for Briana Augustina (née Ottoboni) — a founder and world builder creating stories, platforms, and tools for a more *human* life. The site is a minimal, editorial portfolio showcasing her ventures under the Artisanship umbrella, her origin story, values, and press.

Live URL: brianaaugustina.com **Tech Stack:** Static site (HTML/CSS/JS) or lightweight framework (Next.js, Astro, or equivalent). No CMS required. Deployed to Vercel or Netlify.

Design Language

Aesthetic Direction

The design is **refined editorial minimalism** — closer to a curated art book or print magazine than a typical startup founder site. Think: Kinfolk magazine, Monocle, or a gallerist's personal page.

Color Palette

- **Background:** Warm off-white / cream (`#F5F0EB` or similar parchment tone)
- **Text:** Near-black (`#1A1A1A` or `#111111`)
- **Accent:** Muted red/coral for the location pin icon
- **Links:** Black text, arrow (→) as affordance. No underlines, no blue.
- **Section dividers:** Thin horizontal rules (1px, light gray)

Typography

- **Header font ("BRIANA AUGUSTINA", hero headline, project names, page titles): Times New Briana** — a custom serif typeface created by Briana. File will be provided in the project assets folder. Self-host via `@font-face`. Spaced uppercase for the site title with generous letter-spacing (`0.15em–0.25em`).
- **Subheader / Body font (descriptions, bio copy, nav links, metadata, section labels): Helvetica Neue**. Use the system font stack with Helvetica Neue as primary: `"Helvetica Neue", Helvetica, Arial, sans-serif`.

- **Section labels ("PROJECTS", "WORK", "PRESS", "VALUES", etc.):** Helvetica Neue, all-caps, wide letter-spacing, smaller font size (~11–12px). Feels like a printed section header.
- **Navigation links ("Home", "About", "Portfolio"):** Helvetica Neue, regular weight, sentence case.
- **Metadata text (dates, subtitles):** Helvetica Neue, slightly smaller, regular weight.

Layout Principles

- **Max content width:** ~700px for text content, with generous padding on both sides.
- **Left sidebar navigation:** Fixed/sticky left column (~200px) containing site name, page nav, project links, worlds, and connect links. Visible on desktop; collapses to hamburger or top bar on mobile.
- **Top utility bar:** Shows "Today is [date]" on the left and "📍 San Francisco, CA" on the right, rendered dynamically with JavaScript.
- **Generous vertical whitespace:** Large spacing between sections. Breathing room everywhere.
- **No background colors, no cards, no shadows.** Content floats on the cream background.
- **Section dividers:** Thin horizontal lines separating major content blocks.

Imagery

- **Photo style:** High-quality, warm-toned editorial photography.
- **Object images:** Vintage/artisan objects (old film camera, ammonite fossil, galloping horse, vintage camcorder) used as visual punctuation — scattered on the homepage in an asymmetric, almost collage-like grid. These are NOT stock illustrations; they are specific curated images.
- **Headshot:** Black and white portrait of Briana, used on Homepage footer and About page hero.
- **Portfolio project icons:** Small object images associated with each venture (walkie-talkie device for Walkie Talkie, ammonite for The Corral, vintage camera equipment for The Trades Show, horse for Fractal Studio).

Site Structure

The site has **3 pages:**

Page 1: Homepage (`/`)

Page 2: About (`/about`)

Page 3: Portfolio (`/portfolio`)

Page 1: Homepage

Top Bar

- Left: "Today is March 29, 2026" (dynamically generated via JS — format: `Today is [Month] [Day], [Year]`)
- Right: "📍 San Francisco, CA" (red pin emoji/icon + text)

Hero Section

Headline (large serif):

> I am a Founder & World Builder creating stories, platforms, and tools for a more *human* life.

Note: "human" is italicized.

Image Grid

Below the hero, a loose asymmetric arrangement of 4 curated object images:

1. Vintage film camera (top left area)
2. Galloping horse (top right area)
3. Ammonite/nautilus fossil (bottom left area)
4. Vintage handheld camcorder (bottom right area)

These are positioned with CSS grid or absolute positioning to feel organic and hand-placed, not a rigid 2×2 grid. There are deliberate size differences and offset positioning.

WORK Section

Section label: `WORK` (uppercase, spaced, small)

Four project entries, each with:

- **Project name** (bold, ~18–20px serif)
- **Description** (regular weight, ~15–16px)
- **Arrow link** (→) at the end

Entries:

1. **The Trades Show**

   An interview series on location with modern artisans inside their workshops. Now playing Season 2 in San Francisco. →

2. **The Corral**

   The first AI-powered artisan opportunity board, designed to connect the next generation of craftworkers with jobs, fellowships, residencies, and apprenticeships. →

3. **Walkie Talkie**

   A long-form audio recording tool designed for thinking out loud. →

4. **Fractal Studio**

   Strategy and communications consulting and fractional support for early stage startups doing things differently. →

PRESS Section

Section label: PRESS (uppercase, spaced, small)

Two entries:

1. **The case for Artisan Trades in an AI world | Briana Ottoboni** World Builders Podcast with Jenni Gritters, Jan 2026

2. **Crafting a Modern Career Rooted in Creativity with Briana Ottoboni** The Flourish Careers Podcast with Jennifer Smith, Dec 2025

Press titles are bold/medium weight. Podcast name, host, and date are regular weight below.

Footer

- Tagline: "Everything is connected." (left-aligned, above the image)
- Large black-and-white portrait photo of Briana (takes up most of footer width on left)
- To the right of the photo (vertically centered): "Contact" and "About" links
- Bottom: "Briana Augustina LLC © 2026"

Page 2: About (`/about`)

Top Bar

Same dynamic date + location bar as homepage.

Page Title

> About Briana Ottoboni

Hero Image

Large color portrait photo of Briana (warm tones, editorial style). Full content width.

BIO Section

Section label: `BIO`

Three paragraphs:

> Briana Ottoboni is a San Francisco-based founder and creative who spent years growing brands and startups before deciding to build something of her own.
>
> After apprenticing with a shoe cobbler as the world became more automated, The Trades Show was born as a storytelling medium to highlight artisan pathways in a return to what it means to be human. Since storytelling alone can't sustain an entire industry, she built The Corral next, infrastructure to power the next generation of craftworkers.
>
> Briana operates at the intersection of craft, culture, and technology, creating the stories, tools, and platforms for a more *human* life.

Note: "human" italicized in last paragraph.

WORK Section

Section label: `WORK`

Small row of the same 4 curated object images from homepage, displayed as a horizontal strip of thumbnails. Plus a ladybug image at the end (5 objects total on About page).

VALUES Section

Section label: `VALUES`

Four values, each with a bold name and a question beneath:

1. **Authenticity**

   What would the world look like if everyone showed up as their true authentic selves?

2. **Intentionality**

   How would capitalism change if businesses moved with intention at every scale?

3. **Connection**

   What would change if we viewed life as a web of its connections instead of a ladder?

4. **Craftsmanship**

   What would life look like if everything was designed with craftsmanship and care? From toilet paper to digital spaces?

THE WORLD I'M BUILDING Section

Section label: `THE WORLD I'M BUILDING`

Six short paragraphs:

> The world I'm building is filled with nuance by nature, where distinctions carve paths for connection instead of separation and every piece is a fractal.
>
> Where technology brings us close to our innate humanity.

> Where inner work is a reflection of your outer work.
>
> Where your life's work includes your relationships, your wellbeing, your experiences, not just the work you put into the world.
>
> A world that lives in the fuzzy in between, the connective tissue.

ORIGIN STORY Section

Section label: `ORIGIN STORY`

Seven paragraphs:

> My story lives in the in between, usually finding a happy medium somewhere.
>
> My dad drove a garbage truck while my mom got her PhD.
>
> We lived in Silicon Valley and spent weekends foraging for Porcini.
>
> I went to school in New York City and feel most myself in the farmland of Sonoma County.
>
> I studied business, consult with startups, and now build tech products while I tend a garden, cook & bake, and meditate.
>
> We are taught to fit in, to find our niche, our singular path. Instead through my work and life, I get to honor my multipassionate gifts. In doing so, I hope you get curious about pursuing your own, too.

MORE WAYS TO KNOW ME Section

Section label: `MORE WAYS TO KNOW ME`

Three items displayed as a row of small circular icons with labels beneath:

1. **Manifesting Generator 4/6** (with icon)
2. **Gemini Sun & Moon / Taurus Rising** (with icon)
3. **Eternal Optimist** (with icon — ladybug)

Footer

- "Everything is connected."
- "Briana Augustina LLC © 2026"

Page 3: Portfolio (`/portfolio`)

Top Bar

Same dynamic date + location bar.

Page Title (large serif)

> A record of I've built, what I'm built, and what's coming.

PORTFOLIO Section

Section label: `PORTFOLIO`

Four project cards, each containing:

- **Project image** (curated object photo, left-aligned)
- **Category tag** (e.g., "Technology", "Media", "Consulting" — displayed as a small bordered pill/badge)
- **Project name** (bold, large)
- **Date range** (e.g., "2026 – PRESENT")
- **Description** (multi-line paragraph, right of image)
- **CTA link** (e.g., "Try Walkie Talkie →", "Enter The Corral →", "Watch the show →", "View past work →")

Layout: Two-column for each project — image + metadata on left (~40%), description + CTA on right (~60%). Stacked vertically on mobile.

Project 1: Walkie Talkie

- Image: Vintage walkie-talkie device
- Tag: `Technology`
- Date: 2026 – PRESENT
- Description:

  > A long-form voice-first thinking and recording app. Inspired by old-school handheld recorders.
  >
  > This tool was out of necessity for verbal processors — built for the people who think better out loud, when they're moving, speaking, not typing.

- CTA: Try Walkie Talkie →

Project 2: The Corral

- Image: Galloping horse
- Tag: `Technology`
- Date: 2026 – PRESENT
- Description:

  An AI-powered jobs board for the artisan trades — an online platform for offline jobs. Built to solve a real infrastructure gap: artisans have no centralized, modern place to find opportunities, and employers have no efficient way to find them.

- CTA: Enter The Corral →

Project 3: The Trades Show

- Image: Vintage film camera equipment
- Tag: `Media`
- Date: 2025 – PRESENT
- Description:

  A docu-style interview series following the makers, repairers, and craftspeople keeping their trades alive in American cities. Each season uses a city as a cultural backdrop — exploring not just the work, but the people, the lineages, and the stakes of a trade disappearing. Season 2 — San Francisco, 2026. Premiered March 2026. Episodes follow a bladesmith, a chef, a cobbler, a surfboard shaper, and more — each a study in mastery, community, and the intelligence of the hands.

- CTA: Watch the show →

Project 4: Fractal Studio

- Image: Galloping horse (same horse image)
- Tag: `Consulting`
- Date: 2024 – PRESENT
- Description:

  A communications and strategy consultancy working with early stage startups at the intersection of technology, wellness, and culture. The work that has funded every other venture and sharpened every instinct about how organizations communicate, grow, and find their story.

- CTA: View past work →

PRESS Section

Same as homepage — same two entries.

Footer

- "Everything is connected."
- "Briana Augustina LLC © 2026"

Left Sidebar (Global Navigation)

Present on all pages, fixed/sticky on desktop.

Structure:

BRIANA
AUGUSTINA ← Site name (consistent across all pages)

Home
About
Portfolio

PROJECTS
The Trades Show →
The Corral →
Walkie Talkie →
Fractal Studio →

WORLDS
Artisanship

CONNECT
Contact
LinkedIn
Instagram
Substack
Artisan Newsletter

Note: The site title shows "BRIANA AUGUSTINA" consistently on all pages. Always spaced uppercase.

Section Labels

- "PROJECTS", "WORLDS", "CONNECT" are uppercase, letter-spaced section headers (same style as page section labels).

Arrows

- Project links have a small arrow (→ or ↗) after them, indicating external or deeper links.

Responsive Behavior

Desktop (>1024px)

- Left sidebar visible and sticky
- Two-column layout for portfolio project cards
- Object images on homepage in asymmetric floating layout

Tablet (768–1024px)

- Sidebar collapses to hamburger menu or top nav
- Portfolio cards may shift to stacked layout
- Image grid becomes simpler/smaller

Mobile (<768px)

- Hamburger menu for all navigation
- Single-column layout throughout
- Portfolio cards fully stacked (image above text)
- Object images scale down or display as horizontal scroll
- Generous touch targets (min 44px)

Technical Requirements

Performance

- Lighthouse score target: 95+ on all metrics
- Images: WebP with JPEG fallback, lazy-loaded below fold
- Fonts: Self-hosted or Google Fonts with `font-display: swap`
- Minimal JS — primarily for date rendering and mobile nav toggle

SEO

- Semantic HTML5 (`<header>`, `<nav>`, `<main>`, `<article>`, `<footer>`)
- Open Graph and Twitter Card meta tags
- Descriptive `<title>` per page:
  - Home: "Briana Augustina — Founder & World Builder"
  - About: "About — Briana Augustina"
  - Portfolio: "Portfolio — Briana Augustina"
- `<meta name="description">` per page
- Canonical URLs

Accessibility

- WCAG 2.1 AA compliance
- Alt text on all images
- Keyboard navigable
- Focus indicators on interactive elements
- Sufficient color contrast (cream bg + dark text should pass)
- Skip-to-content link

Dynamic Elements

- **Date display:** `Today is [Month Day, Year]` — rendered client-side with `new Date()`
- **Location:** Static text "San Francisco, CA" with pin icon/emoji
- **No other dynamic content** — all copy is static

External Links

- The Trades Show → thetradesshowpod.com
- The Corral → artisancorral.com
- Walkie Talkie → walkie-talkie-tango.lovable.app (or updated URL)
- Fractal Studio → fractalstudio.work
- Artisanship → (link TBD or section page)
- Contact → mailto:briana@brianaaugustina.com
- LinkedIn → https://www.linkedin.com/in/brianaottoboni/
- Instagram → https://www.instagram.com/brianaaugustina
- Substack → brianaaugustina.substack.com
- Artisan Newsletter → (Substack or separate signup)
- Contact → mailto:briana@brianaaugustina.com

Assets Required

Images (to be provided)

1. Vintage film camera (homepage + portfolio)
2. Galloping horse (homepage + portfolio)
3. Ammonite/nautilus fossil (homepage + portfolio)
4. Vintage handheld camcorder (homepage)
5. Ladybug (About page — values/know me section)
6. Briana headshot — B&W (homepage footer)
7. Briana portrait — color (About page hero)
8. Walkie-talkie device (Portfolio)
9. Additional small icons for "More Ways to Know Me" section (Manifesting Generator, Astrology, Eternal Optimist)

Fonts

- **Times New Briana** (custom font) — font file will be provided in the project assets folder ("Website" folder on desktop). Self-host via `@font-face` with `.woff2` and `.woff` formats for browser compatibility.
- **Helvetica Neue** — system font, use stack: `"Helvetica Neue", Helvetica, Arial, sans-serif`

Image & Font Assets Location

All assets (images + custom font file) will be provided from a local desktop folder titled **"Website"**. Copy into `/public/assets/images/` and `/public/assets/fonts/` respectively.

Implementation Notes for Claude Code

1. **Start with the layout shell** — sidebar + main content area + top utility bar. Get the structural grid right first.
2. **Typography is everything** — Times New Briana (custom serif, self-hosted via `@font-face`) for all headers and the hero headline. Helvetica Neue for all body text, nav, section labels, and metadata. This serif/sans-serif pairing is the site's entire personality. Nail the type system before anything else.
3. **The cream background color must be exact** — sample from the screenshots. It's warm, not yellow, not gray.
4. **Section labels** are a recurring pattern — create a reusable CSS class for the uppercase, letter-spaced, small section headers.

5. **The homepage image grid** is the trickiest layout element — the objects are placed asymmetrically with varying sizes. Use CSS grid with explicit placement or absolute positioning within a relative container.
6. **Keep the CSS minimal and clean** — this design has very few visual elements. The restraint IS the design. No gradients, no shadows, no border-radius, no cards.
7. **Test the sidebar behavior** carefully at breakpoints — it should feel like a magazine's table of contents on desktop and disappear gracefully on mobile.
8. **All arrows (→)** are literal arrow characters, not icon fonts. Use the Unicode character → (U+2192).
9. **"BRIANA AUGUSTINA"** is consistent across all pages — no conditional logic needed for the site name in the sidebar.